Three art directions for a member-led Circles community

Visual and UX exploration only. The same five screens in each route: home, Explore Spaces, a Space page, a discussion and the composer. Nothing here is built, and nothing changes today's Circles.

The premise

- Women follow a few **Spaces**, by life stage or by topic. The feed is member-led: no topic of the day, and no AI post.
- Members start discussions, comment and advise. The composer may offer **optional starter prompts**.
- **Ask Elara stays separate**, in its own tab. It never appears inside a thread.
- No DMs, matchmaking or meetups. Posts are pseudonymous: first names only, as the app shows today, with no photos.

WHAT I INSPECTED IN THE REPO

- The Circle screens and components (`circles/*` , `circle-detail` , `circle-composer` , `post/[id]`).
- Tokens (`packages/tokens` , `components/circles/tokens.ts`) and the Atlas art components.
- `es/circle.ts` , `es/rooms.ts` , `es/common.ts` , `es/atlas.ts` .

Real Spanish, and sample copy

- **From the repo:** *Círculos*, *Mensajes*, *Explorar*, *Responder*, *Esto me resonó*, *Reportar publicación* and its hint, *Ocultar publicación* and its hint, *Di algo amable, o no digas nada.*, *Descartar*, *Buscar ayuda ahora*, *Los círculos no se supervisan de noche*, the six area names (*Claridad con el dinero, Yo, Energía, Propósito, Amor, Día a día*) and the composer's audience note.
- **Marked** MUESTRA **:** “Espacio”, the life-stage names, *Seguir / Siguiendo*, *Empezar una conversación*, the starter prompts, the Space descriptions, the tab labels (Para ti, Recientes, Con respuestas, Guardadas), and all post and comment text.
- All people, posts and comments are fictional.
- No response times and no privacy claims beyond the repo's own sentences.

VISIBILITY AND SAFETY, EVERYWHERE

- An audience sentence in the composer and on every post.
- Report and hide on every post and comment, using the repo's hints.
- The night note and *Buscar ayuda ahora* on Space pages.

Three routes at a glance

Elara Editorial

Open rows on fine rules, terracotta markers, strong serif titles. Densest.

Correspondence

White letters on a warm desk: De / Para lines, date cues, a thread line for replies.

Field Guide

Index plates, glyph tags and area colours, from Atlas. Posts stay plain.

UNDECIDED IN THE PRODUCT (ASSUMED HERE)

- Spaces replace rooms and keep first names. A pseudonym per Space is not assumed.
- Posts have a **title** and a body; today's reflections have no title.
- Comments are one level deep.
- “Siguiendo” has no upper limit shown.

RUTA 1

Elara Editorial

Warm paper, a strong typographic hierarchy, fine rules and small terracotta markers. Mostly open list rows, so the feed reads like a well-set page rather than a stack of boxes.



1 · Inicio de Círculos

Followed Spaces are one text line, not a carousel. The feed is open rows on fine rules: Space, title, byline and count, with a terracotta square for what is new. No daily prompt, no AI post.



2 · Explorar Espacios

Two ways in, never crossed. A life-stage list with follow actions, and the six existing area names as topics. One Space per stage or topic keeps groups from splintering.



3 · Un Espacio

A masthead for the Space, then a list that stays scannable at three to four rows per screen. Starting a post is the one filled action; the night-supervision note stays on the page.

RUTA 1

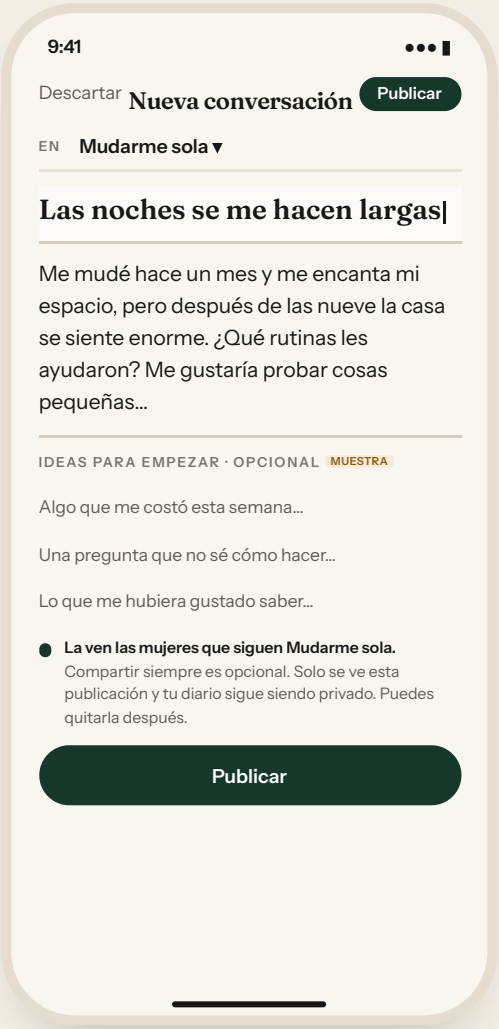
Elara Editorial · pantallas 4 y 5

The reading and writing screens, and the system behind the route.



4 · Conversación

The post reads like an article: a title, one voice, one audience line. Comments are open paragraphs divided by hairlines, each with its own reply and a ··· menu. Report is named on the post itself.



5 · Compositor

Space, title and post stacked on one quiet page. Starter prompts are three plain lines she may ignore. The audience sentence, adapted from the repo's composer note, sits directly above Publicar.

Ivory ground
#F9F5EF

Ink
#1A1615

Terracotta marker
#C94A1C

Fine rule
#D6CBBC

Forest action
#16382A

The system

Type: Fraunces 600 for Space and post titles, Instrument Sans for everything else. Titles 12.5–15 px; metadata 8.5 px.

Density: four to five discussions on the first screen, each a title, a byline and a count.

Material: the paper ground only. Rules instead of boxes, and no card shadows.

Markers: a 5 px terracotta square marks what is new or followed. The only accent.

Navigation: underlined text tabs and a text line of followed Spaces.

Post treatment: open rows; comments are open paragraphs.

Risks

It leans on type and spacing alone. With long Spanish titles it needs a two-line clamp and a large-text check.

RUTA 2

Correspondence

Elara's letter and reflection language, made contemporary: restrained note-like posts, a clear date cue, and a visible thread. No stamps, collage or fold effects.



1 · Inicio de Círculos

Each Space is a folder tab. Each post is a short letter on white sheet: a date cue, a De / Para address line and a two-line excerpt. Fewer posts per screen, richer reading, still no feed of cards.



2 · Explorar Espacios

Life stages and topics are two folders of one drawer. Each entry is an address-book line with one follow action; the second sheet previews the other folder so she knows it exists.



3 · Un Espacio

A letterhead for the Space and a list of letters with date cues. Writing is a pen-line at the foot of the page, the same pattern as Elara's own letters.

RUTA 2

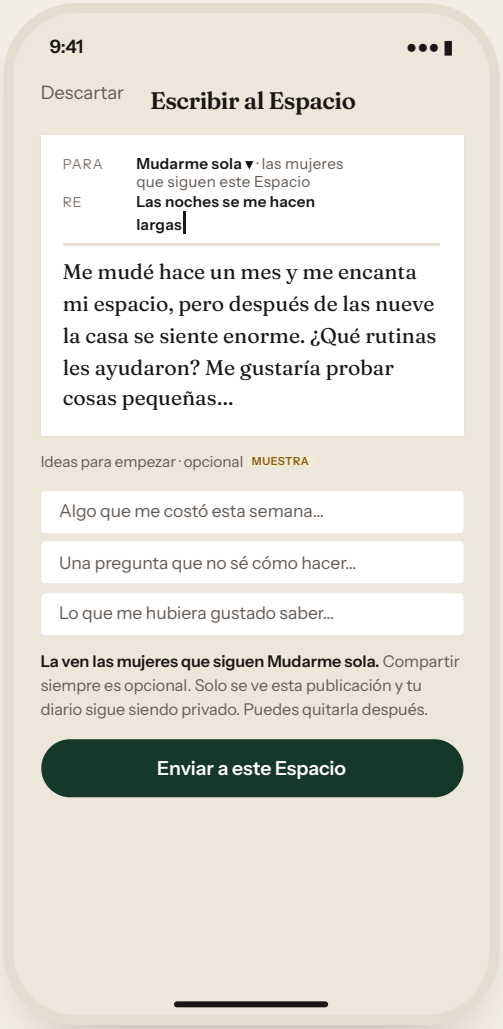
Correspondence · pantallas 4 y 5

The reading and writing screens, and the system behind the route.



4 · Conversación

The original is a full letter; replies are shorter notes hanging on a forest thread line, each with a date cue. Report is spelled out in the letter's footer, ··· on every note.



5 · Compositor

The address block is the audience: Para (Space and who reads it) and Re (the title). Starter ideas sit off the sheet, so choosing one is visibly optional.

Desk
#ECE6DB

Letter
#FFFFFF

Ink
#1A1615

Thread / action
#16382A

Date cue
#C94A1C

The system

Type: Fraunces for letter titles and bodies (a reading face), Instrument Sans caps for De / Para lines and date cues.

Density: two to three letters per screen. The most reading per post, the least scanning.

Material: white sheets on a warmer desk, one hairline edge, no folds, no stamps beyond a small date cue.

Navigation: folder tabs for Spaces and for the two ways to explore.

Post treatment: a letter with a De / Para address; replies as shorter notes on a thread line.

Risks

Letters take vertical space and the address block repeats on every post. It could read as formal for quick advice threads.

RUTA 3

Field Guide

Subtle cues from Elara's paper landscapes and Atlas make Spaces quick to recognise. Posts stay plain and readable; the feed never becomes a map or an illustration.



1 · Inicio de Círculos

Followed Spaces are small index plates with an Atlas-style glyph and the area's colour. Posts are plain readable rows; a thin colour rule and a glyph tag say where each one lives. No map, no illustration.



2 · Explorar Espacios

Life stages are two-column plates, topics are a compact keyed list. The glyph and colour repeat everywhere that Space appears, so she recognises it by sight.



3 · Un Espacio

Identity lives in a short band (glyph, name, faint contour lines). Below it, the discussion list is the same plain rows as home, so the band does not compete with reading.

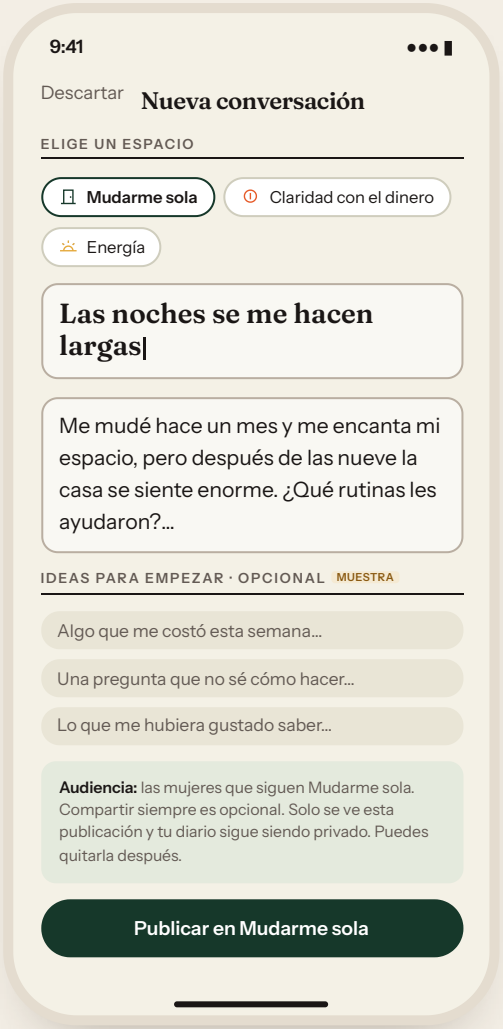
Field Guide · pantallas 4 y 5

The reading and writing screens, and the system behind the route.



4 · Conversación

The post is a plain article under a glyph tag. The ··· menu is shown open, with the repo's own hints, so report and hide read as ordinary, trustworthy choices.



5 · Compositor

Space choice is a row of keyed plates, so the Space's colour follows into the post. Starter ideas are muted chips; the audience is a labelled box just above the button.

Ground
#F4F1E6

Sage plate
#E4EADD

Ink
#1A1615

Area colours
#E65A28 · #16382A · #E5A93C · #1B4232

Forest action
#16382A

The system

Type: Fraunces for Space names and post titles; Instrument Sans 600 caps for section labels, like a guide's index.

Density: four rows per screen, each with a glyph tag and a colour rule.

Material: sage and sand plates behind Spaces only. Faint contour lines appear in one Space band.

Navigation: plates for followed Spaces, a keyed list for topics, a recognisable glyph for each Space.

Post treatment: plain rows. The glyph and a thin colour rule do the identifying.

Risks

A glyph and colour per Space is a design system to maintain as Spaces multiply, and colour must never be the only cue.

COMPARACIÓN Y RECOMENDACIÓN

Elara Editorial supports member-led discussion best, borrowing Correspondence's thread

	1 · ELARA EDITORIAL	2 · CORRESPONDENCE	3 · FIELD GUIDE
Scannability	Best. Four to five threads per screen with a stable title–byline–count pattern.	Weakest. Two to three letters per screen; an address block on every post.	Good. Four rows, with colour and glyph helping recognition.
Reading and replying	Strong. Comments are open paragraphs with their own actions.	Best. The thread line makes who answered whom clear.	Good. Plain, with a left rule per comment.
Finding Spaces	Clear but text-only; two lists with follow links.	Folders are tidy but quiet.	Best. Plates and glyphs make a Space recognisable at a glance.
Visibility and safety	Audience line under the byline, “Reportar publicación” named on the post.	De / Para is the audience, by design.	Labelled audience box; open menu with the repo's hints.
Distance from today's Circles	Smallest. Same paper, type and tokens, with rows replacing cards.	Moderate. Builds on the reflection and letter language.	Largest. New glyph and colour set per Space.
Maintenance	Lowest.	Low.	Highest: glyphs and colours per Space.

RECOMMENDATION

Elara Editorial

A community that is information-dense and member-led needs fast scanning above all. Editorial rows give the most threads per screen without a card stack, and they read as unmistakably Elara: the same paper, Fraunces and terracotta. Take Correspondence's **thread line** for comments and Field Guide's **glyph tag** for Space recognition only if a Space needs help to be recognised.

RETAIN FROM TODAY'S CIRCLES

- The ivory ground, Fraunces and Instrument Sans, forest buttons and terracotta accent.
- First names only, no photos; “Esto me resonó”, “Responder”, the ⋯ menu and its hints.
- The composer's audience note and “Puedes quitarla después”.
- The night-supervision note and *Buscar ayuda ahora*.
- Ask Elara as its own tab.

SMALLEST SLICE TO TEST FIRST

The discussion row and the comment list in the Editorial style, applied to the existing post list and the existing post detail. No new Spaces, tabs, follow model or composer. Test with the current members whether they scan titles, bylines and counts faster, and whether they find report and hide.

ASSUMPTIONS NOT YET DECIDED

- Spaces replacing rooms, and how many can be followed.
- Titles on posts; first name versus an alias.
- Comment depth, sort order, and who can start a Space.
- Moderation capacity as volume grows; no response time is stated anywhere.